

All, each, every, and none

Learner workbook

Describe a whole group or its individual members.

Understand the distinction

All usually treats the group together: All the students are here. Each and every normally take a singular noun and singular verb: Each student has a book; every room is ready. Each highlights individuals; every emphasizes the whole set.

Use each of the students, not every of the students. None of takes a plural or uncountable noun phrase. With a plural noun, either singular or plural agreement can occur depending on meaning and style: None of the seats is/are free.

Compare the patterns

GROUP

All the rooms are ready.

The rooms are considered together.

INDIVIDUALS

Each room has a key.

Consider the rooms one by one.

ZERO

None of the water is clean.

The uncountable water takes is.

Read each example. Explain what the highlighted choice means in context. Then cover the example and say a similar sentence.

Check your understanding

Write before looking at the answers. The guide gives a model answer and explains the choice. Other wording can be correct.

1. Complete: Every student ___ a notebook. (has / have)

2. Correct this: Every of the rooms is ready.

3. Must None of the seats are free always be changed to is?

Use it in your own life

Describe what everyone in a group has and what no one has.

Self-check

Does your sentence express your intended meaning? Does its form follow the relevant pattern? Can a reader understand the context?

Try again

After checking the explanation, revise your sentence. Say it aloud or use it in a short conversation.

Answers and explanation

1. has

Every + singular noun normally takes a singular verb.

2. Each of the rooms is ready.

Alternatively: Every room is ready.

3. No. Plural agreement is accepted with a plural noun.

Meaning and style can guide the choice.

One possible response

Every student has a pencil. None of the students has a calculator.

This is a model, not the only acceptable answer. Assess meaning, grammar, and context together.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-23.html